

- *Document management*—This is a broad class of sites where some content gets served from the filesystem instead of in the ORM. Typically, the ORM contains a lightweight object that points to the file on the server or CDN. Users then interact with pages to see or download the documents. Video sites are a version of this, where the document is a movie file. Data scientists use this kind of site for presenting reports or results from their analysis.
- *Utility sites*—It is quite common for developers and system administrators to create utility scripts solving specific problems in an organization. Often, these scripts are difficult to share, as they're environment specific. Creating a web frontend for these kinds of utilities makes them useful to a wider audience within an organization. Similarly, most companies have share folders full of Excel files that are ad-hoc solutions to a problem. Excel can be a fragile beast; there is seldom any input validation, and a small change in the wrong cell can produce the wrong result. Processes like this that are used by many people call out for a web version, converting the logic in Excel into a web application providing input validation and robustness.

Orthogonal to the type of site, is your architectural approach. Your project may use one or more of the following design concepts:

- *Single-page applications*—Not so much a type of project but a design approach, SPAs can be built with Django as their API backend. Third-party libraries, like Django Ninja, simplify the creation of these kinds of projects.
- *Multiuser sites*—Django includes user account management out of the box. The Django Admin can be used to administer user accounts, and Django provides views for login and password management.
- *Multilingual sites*—Django includes mechanisms for handling multiple written languages and localization, such as date and currency format. This can be especially powerful when mixed in with multiuser capabilities, as users see the site in their native language.
- *Static-page sites*—For speed of interaction, nothing beats a static website, where the server feeds the user straight HTML. Of course, maintaining these kinds of sites can be painful, unless you use tools that allow you to compose the page. The third-party library `django-distill` is a site generator; you build a Django site like you normally would then use `distill` to output it as a static site. This gives you all the advantages of the Django template engine while keeping the performance gain of a static site.

1.2.4 The RiffMates project

Books are great (you should buy multiple copies for your friends), but practice is where you really learn things. This book presents a project called *RiffMates*, where you help your cousin build a musicians-seeking-musicians personals site. This project is primarily the content site type, but it mixes in some document management aspects, all in a multiuser context. Coding along will help you better understand how to build